

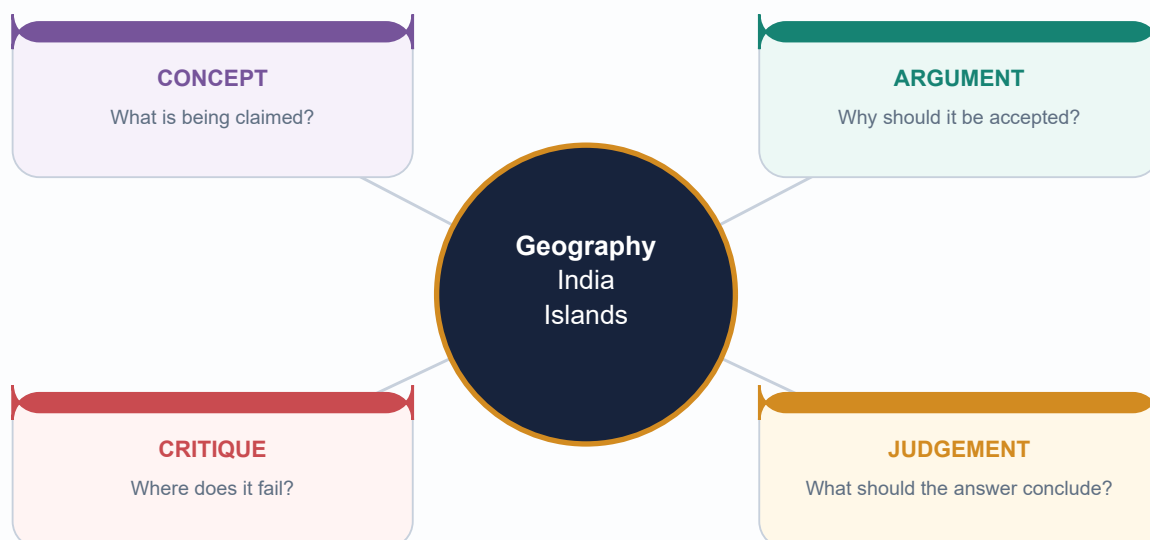
PREMIUM SOLVED WORKBOOK

# Geography 11 - India Islands and Great Nicobar - Solved Workbook

Export date: 16 August 2026

Fixed PYQ options retained; authored MCQs rotate A -&gt; B -&gt; C -&gt; D

Inferred/provisional objective keys are explicitly labelled



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

## HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

## Workbook instructions and verification ledger

GS-I / GS-III  
Geography

## INTRO &amp; ORIGIN

Attempt fixed PYQs without changing historical option order. Authored questions 1-40 rotate A -> B -> C -> D continuously.

## KEY DATA

| Set                    | Status                                                                                            |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2018 Barren and coral  | official question text verified; answer inferred, high confidence; local official key unavailable |
| 2019, 2023, 2025 Mains | question demand locally routed/verified; model answers original                                   |
| 2022 Biorock           | official question text verified; answer inferred, high confidence; local official key unavailable |
| 2026 climate           | official Set-A question locally verified; key provisional B                                       |
| Authored MCQs          | 40 questions; strict A-B-C-D rotation                                                             |

## STATIC THEORY

- Every Mains solution follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.
- Every Mains solution is followed by 'Why this earns marks'.
- Do not treat inferred or provisional objective answers as final official keys.

## MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Use elimination before explanation.
2. Review error clusters by module.

## UPSC TRAPS

**WRONG:** A solved workbook is an official UPSC answer key.

**CORRECT:** Only the explicitly identified key status is claimed.

## MAINS ANGLE

*Examiner-grade practice, not a substitute for official keys.*

## STUDY LINK

[Reusable Markdown source register.](#)

HIGH

## PYQ 1 - UPSC Prelims 2018: Barren Island

GS-I / GS-III  
Geography

## NEWS TRIGGER

Question: Consider statements - (1) Barren Island volcano is an active volcano located in Indian territory; (2) it lies about 140 km east of Great Nicobar; (3) it last erupted in 1991 and has remained inactive since. Options: A 1 only; B 2 and 3 only; C 3 only; D 1 and 3 only.

**STATIC THEORY**

- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED IN THE LOCAL KEY SET: A, statement 1 only. Confidence: high.
- Statement 1 is correct: Barren Island is the standard active-volcano example in Indian territory.
- Statement 2 is false: the location/distance relative to Great Nicobar is wrong.
- Statement 3 is false: 1991 did not mark permanent inactivity.
- Elimination: statements 2 and 3 contain the decisive errors.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Question text locally verified against the official scan.
2. Historical option order retained.

**UPSC TRAPS**

**WRONG:** Treating an eruption year as a permanent status.

**CORRECT:** Activity status must be updated and sourced.

**MAINS ANGLE**

*Prelims route: location + activity + chronology.*

**STUDY LINK**

Main Modules 3-4.

**HIGH****PYQ 2 - UPSC Prelims 2018: coral distribution and diversity**

GS-I / GS-III  
Geography

**NEWS TRIGGER**

Question statements: (1) Most world coral reefs are in tropical waters; (2) more than one-third are in territories of Australia, Indonesia and Philippines; (3) reefs host far more animal phyla than tropical rainforests. Options A 1&2; B 3; C 1&3; D 1,2,3.

**STATIC THEORY**

- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED IN THE LOCAL KEY SET: D, all three. Confidence: high.
- Tropical shallow clear waters support most reef-building corals.
- The country-territory concentration is accepted in the UPSC framing.
- Reefs support exceptionally high animal-phyla diversity.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Do not convert high phyla diversity into a claim that every reef has more species than every rainforest.

**UPSC TRAPS**

**WRONG:** Tropical distribution means reefs occur only at the equator.

**CORRECT:** Suitable currents and local conditions matter within the broad tropical belt.

**MAINS ANGLE**

*Prelims route: distribution, concentration and biodiversity metric.*

**STUDY LINK**

Main Modules 2 and 11.

HIGH

## PYQ 3 - UPSC Mains 2019 GS-I: coral warming

GS-I / GS-III  
Geography

## NEWS TRIGGER

Assess the impact of global warming on the coral life system with examples. 10 marks, 150 words.

## STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Warming damages coral systems through marine heatwaves that disrupt coral-zooxanthellae symbiosis, causing bleaching, mortality and loss of reef complexity.
- NAMED EVIDENCE: Repeated Great Barrier Reef bleaching and heat stress in Lakshadweep, Gulf of Mannar and A&N show global forcing interacting with local water quality.
- ANALYSIS: Reef degradation reduces fisheries habitat, tourism, biodiversity, carbonate sediment supply and wave-energy attenuation. Acidification simultaneously makes calcification harder.
- QUALIFICATION: Bleaching is not instant death; recovery depends on heat duration, recurrence, tolerant colonies, recruitment and low local stress.
- VERDICT: Rapid emissions mitigation must be combined with sewage/sediment control, fisheries governance, anchor/light controls and heat-response monitoring.
- Why this earns marks: it links climate to coral biology, services and Indian examples, distinguishes bleaching from death and ends with global-plus-local action.

## MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Warming and acidification are distinct but compounding.
2. Restoration does not replace emissions cuts.

## UPSC TRAPS

**WRONG:** Bleaching and acidification are synonyms.

**CORRECT:** One disrupts symbiosis; the other changes carbonate chemistry.

## MAINS ANGLE

*Mechanism -> service loss -> qualification -> two-scale response.*

## STUDY LINK

Main Module 11.

HIGH

## PYQ 4 - UPSC Prelims 2022: Biorock

GS-I / GS-III  
Geography

## NEWS TRIGGER

"Biorock technology" is talked about in which situation? A restoration of damaged coral reefs; B building material from plant residues; C shale-gas exploration; D salt licks for wildlife.

## STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED IN THE LOCAL KEY SET: A. Confidence: high.
- Low-voltage mineral accretion encourages calcium-carbonate deposition on submerged frames and can support coral attachment/growth.
- It cannot remove heat stress, acidification, sewage, sediment or destructive fishing.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Restoration is a supplementary intervention.
2. Question text locally verified.

**UPSC TRAPS**

**WRONG:** Technology restores the whole reef system automatically.

**CORRECT:** Site stressors and ecological function still require management.

**MAINS ANGLE**

*Use as a bounded restoration example.*

**STUDY LINK**

Main Modules 11 and 23.

**HIGH****PYQ 5 - UPSC Mains 2023 GS-I: coast resources and preparedness**GS-I / GS-III  
Geography**NEWS TRIGGER**

Comment on the resource potentials of the long coastline of India and highlight the status of natural hazard preparedness in these areas. 15 marks, 250 words.

**STATIC THEORY**

- CLAIM: India's coast and islands are fisheries, port, tourism, energy and ecosystem-service frontiers whose value depends on risk-sensitive development.
- NAMED EVIDENCE: A&N's Sunda-Andaman setting and the 2004 tsunami show tectonic exposure; INCOIS provides seismic-ocean-model advisory capability; Odisha demonstrates evacuation and shelters.
- ANALYSIS: Resources include ports, transshipment, fisheries, offshore energy and blue carbon. Hazards include cyclone, surge, erosion, tsunami, flooding and salinisation; dense settlements and lifelines amplify risk.
- QUALIFICATION: Warning-centre capacity, CRZ clearance or sea walls do not prove uniform preparedness; routes, shelters, land use, maintenance and trust determine outcomes.
- VERDICT: Integrate coastal resource planning with hazard maps, ecosystem thresholds, resilient lifelines, local drills and livelihood access.
- Why this earns marks: it answers resources before preparedness, uses named Indian evidence and separates capability from outcome.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Cross-cutting route; main owner is Geography coast.
2. Island examples sharpen the hazard dimension.

**UPSC TRAPS**

**WRONG:** Turning the answer into only tsunami management.

**CORRECT:** Cover resources and the full coastal hazard stack.

**MAINS ANGLE**

*Map + resource-risk matrix + preparedness qualification.*

**STUDY LINK**

Geography Topic 10 and Main Modules 13-14.

HIGH

**PYQ 6 - UPSC Mains 2025 GS-I: island nations and sea-level rise**GS-I / GS-III  
Geography**NEWS TRIGGER**

How are climate change and the sea level rise affecting the very existence of many island nations? Discuss with examples. 10 marks, 150 words.

**STATIC THEORY**

- CLAIM: Sea-level rise becomes existential when low islands lose habitable land, freshwater, reef sediment, livelihoods, cultural sites and fiscal capacity faster than they can adapt.

- NAMED EVIDENCE: Maldives, Tuvalu and Kiribati illustrate low elevation, saline intrusion, erosion and relocation/statehood concerns; Lakshadweep provides an Indian reef-island analogue without being a sovereign island nation.

- ANALYSIS: Thermal expansion and land-ice melt raise mean sea level; storms and waves cause episodic overwash; warming/acidification weaken reefs that supply sediment and protection.

- QUALIFICATION: Island response is not uniform or automatic drowning; accretion, migration, engineered protection and adaptation differ, but require healthy reefs, finance and land.

- VERDICT: Deep emissions cuts, adaptation finance, freshwater and reef protection, planned mobility and legal protection of statehood/rights must proceed together.

- Why this earns marks: it goes beyond inundation to habitability, names examples, explains interacting mechanisms and qualifies deterministic narratives.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Water security may fail before land disappears.
2. Sovereignty/statehood is an advanced dimension.

**UPSC TRAPS**

**WRONG:** All islands will vanish on one date.

**CORRECT:** Exposure, morphology and adaptation vary.

**MAINS ANGLE**

*Existence = land + water + economy + culture + legal identity.*

**STUDY LINK**

Main Modules 5, 11-12.

HIGH

**PYQ 7 - UPSC Mains 2025 GS-I: tsunami**GS-I / GS-III  
Geography**NEWS TRIGGER**

What are Tsunamis? How and where are they formed? What are their consequences? Explain with examples. 10 marks, 150 words.

**STATIC THEORY**

- CLAIM: Tsunamis are long-period displacement waves generated when a disturbance rapidly moves a large water column, commonly through vertical seabed movement at a subduction earthquake.
- NAMED EVIDENCE: The 26 Dec 2004 Sumatra-Andaman event caused severe Indian Ocean impacts including A&N and India's east/south coasts. Volcanic collapse and submarine landslides are alternative triggers.
- ANALYSIS: Deep-ocean waves travel fast with low amplitude; shoaling slows and steepens them, producing inundation, currents, debris, erosion, salinisation and cascading lifeline failure.
- QUALIFICATION: Not every submarine earthquake generates a tsunami; magnitude, depth, fault motion, displacement, bathymetry and coast shape matter.
- VERDICT: INCOIS detection/model advisories must be completed by redundant alerts, routes, drills, land-use control and accessible evacuation.
- Why this earns marks: every directive word is answered with mechanism, place, consequence, example and qualification.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Tsunami is not a tide.
2. Shoaling explains coastal amplification.

**UPSC TRAPS****WRONG:** Wait for sea withdrawal.**CORRECT:** Natural cues vary; follow immediate evacuation guidance.**MAINS ANGLE***Definition -> source -> shoaling -> consequence -> response.***STUDY LINK**

Main Modules 13-14.

**HIGH****PYQ 8 - UPSC Prelims 2026 Q33: A&N climate****GS-I / GS-III**  
Geography**NEWS TRIGGER**

Statements: (1) humid tropical coastal climate; (2) rainfall from South-west and North-east monsoons; (3) maximum precipitation between December and May. Options A 1; B 1&2; C 2&3; D 3.

**STATIC THEORY**

- PROVISIONAL LOCAL SET-A KEY: B, statements 1 and 2. This is not labelled final.
- Statement 1 is correct: oceanic tropical setting produces warm, humid coastal conditions.
- Statement 2 is correct: both monsoon systems contribute.
- Statement 3 is false: December-May is not the maximum-precipitation period.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Question text locally verified from 2026 Set-A paper.
2. Key read from provisional local Set-A key.

**UPSC TRAPS****WRONG:** Both monsoons means uniform rainfall all year.**CORRECT:** Seasonality and peak months still matter.**MAINS ANGLE***Climate linkage: maritime humidity + monsoon pathways + relief.***STUDY LINK**

Main Module 7.

HIGH

## Hard MCQs 1-4 - continuous rotation

GS-I / GS-III  
Geography

## STATIC THEORY

- Q1. Which is the best classification principle for an archipelago? Options: A It is a group term and does not itself identify geological origin. | B It means every island is continental. | C It means every island is volcanic. | D It means every island is an atoll.. Answer A. Archipelago is a grouping term; origin must be established separately.
- Q2. Which feature most clearly identifies a barrier reef? Options: A A reef with no relation to land. | B A reef separated from land by a relatively wide lagoon. | C A high volcanic cone. | D A tidal creek through mangroves.. Answer B. The lagoon separating reef and land is the key distinction.
- Q3. The Andaman-Nicobar chain is best understood as: Options: A a uniform chain of coral atolls | B a passive continental margin | C a subduction-related arc/forearc-accretionary system with mixed island origins | D a single uplifted delta. Answer C. The convergent-margin setting explains mixed tectonic, sedimentary and volcanic components.
- Q4. Which statement is the safest? Options: A All A&N islands are volcanic. | B All Nicobar islands are coral cays. | C Barren and Narcondam prove a uniform origin. | D Barren is volcanic, but the wider archipelago is not uniformly volcanic.. Answer D. A precise example should not be generalised to the whole chain.

## MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Keys: A-B-C-D.
2. Read the explanation only after attempting.

## UPSC TRAPS

**WRONG:** Using the visible rotation to guess.**CORRECT:** Rotation is for authoring audit; solve the mechanism.

## MAINS ANGLE

*Convert every wrong option into one-line correction.*

## STUDY LINK

Main modules relevant to Q1-Q4.

HIGH

## Hard MCQs 5-8 - continuous rotation

GS-I / GS-III  
Geography

## STATIC THEORY

- Q5. Barren Island is exam-safe as: Options: A India's only historically active / active volcano | B India's largest atoll | C the southernmost point of India | D a continental shelf island in Lakshadweep. Answer A. Activity-date details still require a dated official source.
- Q6. What is the best treatment of Narcondam? Options: A Call it a coral atoll. | B Call it volcanic and avoid an unsourced timeless active/dormant binary. | C Call it India's only active volcano. | D Treat it as part of Lakshadweep.. Answer B. Origin is certain; simplified activity labels may be source-sensitive.
- Q7. Darwin's subsidence model explains: Options: A river capture | B delta switching | C fringing reef -> barrier reef -> atoll as the foundation subsides | D formation of a tectonic trench. Answer C. Coral growth keeps pace with a subsiding volcanic foundation in the model.
- Q8. Why is a Lakshadweep cay not stable bedrock? Options: A It is made only of clay. | B It is permanently floating. | C It is a lava raft. | D It is reef-derived sediment redistributed by waves and currents.. Answer D. Reef production and sediment transport maintain the visible island.



**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Keys: A-B-C-D.
2. Read the explanation only after attempting.

**UPSC TRAPS****WRONG:** Using the visible rotation to guess.**CORRECT:** Rotation is for authoring audit; solve the mechanism.**MAINS ANGLE***Convert every wrong option into one-line correction.***STUDY LINK**

Main modules relevant to Q5-Q8.

**HIGH****Hard MCQs 9-12 - continuous rotation****GS-I / GS-III**

Geography

**STATIC THEORY**

- Q9. Which channel separates the Andaman and Nicobar groups? Options: A Ten Degree Channel | B Nine Degree Channel | C Eight Degree Channel | D Palk Strait. Answer A. Ten Degree Channel is the standard group separator.
- Q10. Which statement is correct? Options: A Minicoy is north of Nine Degree Channel. | B Minicoy lies south of Nine Degree Channel. | C Eight Degree Channel separates Andaman and Nicobar. | D Ten Degree Channel separates Minicoy and Maldives.. Answer B. Nine Degree Channel separates Minicoy from the main Lakshadweep cluster.
- Q11. Which combination best describes Great Nicobar? Options: A low atoll, no streams, arid scrub | B deltaic island in the Ganga-Brahmaputra | C high-relief humid tropical island with short catchments and diverse coastal ecosystems | D volcanic cone without rainforest. Answer C. High relief, rainfall, streams and rainforest/coastal mosaics are central.
- Q12. Which distinction is correct? Options: A UNESCO recognition replaces wildlife law. | B A biosphere transition zone is unregulated. | C National park and biosphere reserve are synonyms. | D National-park law, biosphere zoning and UNESCO recognition are distinct.. Answer D. They operate through different legal and governance instruments.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Keys: A-B-C-D.
2. Read the explanation only after attempting.

**UPSC TRAPS****WRONG:** Using the visible rotation to guess.**CORRECT:** Rotation is for authoring audit; solve the mechanism.**MAINS ANGLE***Convert every wrong option into one-line correction.***STUDY LINK**

Main modules relevant to Q9-Q12.

**HIGH****Hard MCQs 13-16 - continuous rotation****GS-I / GS-III**

Geography

**STATIC THEORY**

- Q13. Isolation can increase extinction risk mainly because: Options: A small populations and narrow ranges have low redundancy | B it guarantees unlimited immigration | C it prevents endemism | D it removes invasive-species risk. Answer A. Small, isolated populations have fewer rescue options.
- Q14. Species-area relation generally predicts that: Options: A smaller islands always have more species | B larger and more heterogeneous islands tend to support more species | C area is irrelevant | D all islands have equal richness. Answer B. Area and habitat diversity raise carrying opportunities, all else equal.
- Q15. Which ecosystem-service statement is best? Options: A Corals eliminate tsunami risk. | B Mangroves create freshwater. | C Reefs, mangroves and seagrass provide different services with ecological thresholds. | D Littoral forest makes evacuation unnecessary.. Answer C. Services are real but conditional and non-substitutable.
- Q16. What is the first freshwater warning on a low reef island? Options: A glacier retreat | B deep river incision | C volcanic ash | D salinisation of the rain-fed freshwater lens. Answer D. Overwash, pumping and sea-level rise threaten the thin lens.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Keys: A-B-C-D.
2. Read the explanation only after attempting.

**UPSC TRAPS****WRONG:** Using the visible rotation to guess.**CORRECT:** Rotation is for authoring audit; solve the mechanism.**MAINS ANGLE***Convert every wrong option into one-line correction.***STUDY LINK**

Main modules relevant to Q13-Q16.

**HIGH****Hard MCQs 17-20 - continuous rotation****GS-I / GS-III**

Geography

**STATIC THEORY**

- Q17. A multi-hazard Great Nicobar plan must begin by: Options: A linking hazards to exposure, vulnerability and lifeline cascades | B assuming one design event covers all hazards | C ignoring vertical land movement | D treating cyclone and tsunami as identical. Answer A. Risk is not a hazard list; it is a system of consequences.
- Q18. A major undersea earthquake generates a tsunami only when: Options: A it occurs at any depth with no displacement | B it rapidly displaces a large water column, commonly through vertical seabed motion | C wind speed is high | D the tide is spring tide. Answer B. Water-column displacement is the decisive mechanism.
- Q19. Which sequence is correct? Options: A evacuation -> earthquake -> sensor | B tide gauge -> no modelling -> all-clear | C seismic detection -> ocean observations/modelling -> advisory -> dissemination -> evacuation | D port closure -> coral growth -> warning. Answer C. Warning is an end-to-end chain.
- Q20. The 2004 A&N lesson is best stated as: Options: A all islands subsided equally | B only tsunami waves mattered | C Indira Point rose sharply | D uplift, subsidence and inundation varied spatially across an active margin. Answer D. Coseismic deformation is spatially variable.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Keys: A-B-C-D.
2. Read the explanation only after attempting.

**UPSC TRAPS****WRONG:** Using the visible rotation to guess.**CORRECT:** Rotation is for authoring audit; solve the mechanism.**MAINS ANGLE***Convert every wrong option into one-line correction.***STUDY LINK**

Main modules relevant to Q17-Q20.

**HIGH****Hard MCQs 21-24 - continuous rotation****GS-I / GS-III**

Geography

**STATIC THEORY**

- Q21. Which list contains the five officially listed A&N PVTGs? Options: A Great Andamanese, Jarawa, Onge, Sentinelese and Shompen | B Nicobarese, Shompen, Toda, Kota and Onge | C Jarawa, Nicobarese, Bhil, Onge and Shompen | D Sentinelese, Nicobarese, Toda, Onge and Kadar. Answer A. Nicobarese are Scheduled Tribes but not in the official five A&N PVTGs.

- Q22. Which statement is correct? Options: A All Scheduled Tribes are automatically PVTGs. | B Nicobarese are STs but not among the five A&N PVTGs. | C PVTG is a biological category. | D Shompen are not Scheduled Tribes.. Answer B. The administrative classifications must be kept distinct.

- Q23. The Shompen Policy's core approach is: Options: A forced assimilation | B unrestricted tourism contact | C social-cultural integrity, protection and willingness-sensitive communication | D publication of detailed contact locations. Answer C. The policy centres integrity and protection.

- Q24. Why are sensitive contact locations excluded? Options: A They are irrelevant to rights. | B They are all military secrets. | C They do not exist. | D Disclosure can undermine restricted-contact, health and safety safeguards.. Answer D. Ethical learning does not require operational detail.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Keys: A-B-C-D.

2. Read the explanation only after attempting.

**UPSC TRAPS**

**WRONG:** Using the visible rotation to guess.

**CORRECT:** Rotation is for authoring audit; solve the mechanism.

**MAINS ANGLE**

Convert every wrong option into one-line correction.

**STUDY LINK**

Main modules relevant to Q21-Q24.

**HIGH****Hard MCQs 25-28 - continuous rotation**

**GS-I / GS-III**  
Geography

**STATIC THEORY**

- Q25. Great Nicobar's strategic value is best framed as: Options: A location plus resilient capabilities for logistics, awareness and HADR | B automatic ownership of Malacca Strait | C guaranteed capture of all shipping | D freedom from environmental law. Answer A. Location matters through capability and resilience.

- Q26. Which is the correct qualification? Options: A A nearby island legally closes an international strait. | B Proximity does not by itself amount to deterministic chokepoint control. | C Commercial and military tests are identical. | D Environment has no strategic value.. Answer B. Power depends on capabilities, law, networks and adversary response.

- Q27. Which set matches the official Great Nicobar architecture? Options: A dam, steel plant, metro and coal mine | B only a port | C transshipment port, airport, township and power infrastructure | D only tourism cottages. Answer C. The project is an integrated four-component plan.

- Q28. Which status sequence is correct? Options: A construction -> proposal -> appraisal | B EC -> no need for forest approval | C major-port notification -> automatic Stage-II | D proposal/appraisal -> conditional clearances -> final approvals -> implementation/tender -> construction/outcome. Answer D. Stages must not be collapsed.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Keys: A-B-C-D.
2. Read the explanation only after attempting.

**UPSC TRAPS****WRONG:** Using the visible rotation to guess.**CORRECT:** Rotation is for authoring audit; solve the mechanism.**MAINS ANGLE***Convert every wrong option into one-line correction.***STUDY LINK**

Main modules relevant to Q25-Q28.

**HIGH****Hard MCQs 29-32 - continuous rotation****GS-I / GS-III**

Geography

**STATIC THEORY**

- Q29. What does an environmental clearance prove? Options: A Permission subject to conditions, not zero impact or successful outcome | B all forest land has been transferred | C all litigation is closed | D every mitigation has succeeded. Answer A. Clearance and outcome are separate.

- Q30. Why do official port figures differ? Options: A One source must be fabricated. | B They reflect different dates, phases and planning scopes and must be cited separately. | C TEU and rupees are interchangeable. | D Capacity never changes during planning.. Answer B. A source-date matrix is the safe method.

- Q31. Which is the strongest trade-off framing? Options: A strategic benefits make ecology irrelevant | B all development is impossible | C test legitimate benefits against irreversible habitat, hazard, water, waste and rights constraints | D count only project expenditure. Answer C. Balanced appraisal evaluates both benefits and residual limits.

- Q32. Why are offsets limited? Options: A They are always illegal. | B They cost too little. | C They never involve trees. | D They cannot fully recreate old-growth, endemic relationships or cultural landscapes elsewhere.. Answer D. Ecological equivalence has hard limits.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Keys: A-B-C-D.
2. Read the explanation only after attempting.

**UPSC TRAPS****WRONG:** Using the visible rotation to guess.**CORRECT:** Rotation is for authoring audit; solve the mechanism.**MAINS ANGLE***Convert every wrong option into one-line correction.***STUDY LINK**

Main modules relevant to Q29-Q32.

**HIGH****Hard MCQs 33-36 - continuous rotation****GS-I / GS-III**

Geography

**STATIC THEORY**

- Q33. The mitigation hierarchy begins with: Options: A avoidance of critical impacts | B offsetting | C post-damage compensation only | D public relations. Answer A. Avoidance is stronger than repair.

- Q34. Best turtle-light control combines: Options: A brighter white light | B shielding, low-impact spectra, timing and enforceable dark zones | C lighting the beach all night | D moving nests without assessment. Answer B. Light management needs multiple enforceable controls.

- Q35. A sound sediment-water plan should monitor: Options: A only annual rainfall | B only port revenue | C turbidity, dredging, reef sediment, catchment yield, storage and demand | D only tree-planting count. Answer C. The two budgets connect ecology and carrying capacity.

- Q36. An adaptive trigger means: Options: A monitoring without decisions | B a promise to review someday | C automatic expansion | D a pre-agreed threshold that pauses, redesigns or stops activity. Answer D. Triggers make monitoring consequential.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Keys: A-B-C-D.
2. Read the explanation only after attempting.

**UPSC TRAPS****WRONG:** Using the visible rotation to guess.**CORRECT:** Rotation is for authoring audit; solve the mechanism.**MAINS ANGLE***Convert every wrong option into one-line correction.***STUDY LINK**

Main modules relevant to Q33-Q36.

**HIGH****Hard MCQs 37-40 - continuous rotation****GS-I / GS-III**

Geography

**STATIC THEORY**

- Q37. As of 12 Feb 2026, the official parliamentary position was: Options: A Stage-II forest approval had not been granted. | B the entire project was complete | C all cases were dismissed | D forest law did not apply. Answer A. The answer is the controlling retrieved status statement.

- Q38. How should the 2023 NGT reference and later cases be read? Options: A Later cases do not matter. | B The 2023 order can be cited, but 2024-25 matters listed in Parliament prevent a final-closure claim. | C PIB is a court. | D Litigation automatically cancels the EC.. Answer B. The record is time-layered.

- Q39. Which pair correctly answers the 2026 climate PYQ? Options: A statements 2 and 3 | B statement 3 only | C statements 1 and 2 | D all three. Answer C. The provisional Set-A key is B in historical option lettering, corresponding to statements 1 and 2; this authored MCQ's correct option is C.

- Q40. The best final verdict is: Options: A approve every phase immediately | B reject all island infrastructure categorically | C rely only on offsets | D use no-go assets, phase gates, independent monitoring and enforceable stop/go thresholds. Answer D. A conditional adaptive approach respects both strategic aims and hard limits.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Keys: A-B-C-D.
2. Read the explanation only after attempting.

**UPSC TRAPS****WRONG:** Using the visible rotation to guess.**CORRECT:** Rotation is for authoring audit; solve the mechanism.**MAINS ANGLE***Convert every wrong option into one-line correction.***STUDY LINK**

Main modules relevant to Q37-Q40.

**HIGH****Original Mains practice 1 - 10 marks: map-ready distribution****GS-I / GS-III**

Geography

**NEWS TRIGGER**

Draw a schematic map and explain how channels organise the geography of India's island groups. Answer in 150 words.

**STATIC THEORY**

- CLAIM: Channels are relational map markers that divide island groups and connect them to wider maritime space.
- NAMED EVIDENCE: Ten Degree Channel separates Andaman and Nicobar; Nine Degree Channel places Minicoy south of the main Lakshadweep group; Eight Degree Channel lies between Minicoy and Maldives; Six Degree/Great Channel lies south of Great Nicobar.
- ANALYSIS: These passages shape navigation, regional orientation, ecological connectivity and strategic geography, while island relief/origin remains independent.
- QUALIFICATION: A channel's proximity does not imply exclusive control, and schematic maps are not navigation charts.
- VERDICT: Use a clean north-south map with only relevant islands and channels.
- Why this earns marks: it provides correct relationships, a diagram plan and a strategic qualification.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Map labels: North/Middle/South Andaman, Little Andaman, Car Nicobar, Great Nicobar, Minicoy.

**UPSC TRAPS**

**WRONG:** Adding many uncertain channels.

**CORRECT:** Accuracy beats label density.

**MAINS ANGLE**

Map + three relationships + qualification.

**STUDY LINK**

Main Module 6.

**HIGH****Original Mains practice 2 - 10 marks: island biogeography**

GS-I / GS-III  
Geography

**NEWS TRIGGER**

Why are island ecosystems often both highly distinctive and highly vulnerable? Answer in 150 words.

**STATIC THEORY**

- CLAIM: Isolation can generate endemism, while small area, small populations and low rescue rates increase vulnerability.
- NAMED EVIDENCE: Great Nicobar's endemic fauna and habitat mosaics illustrate narrow-range dependence; Lakshadweep's reef islands show dependence on one carbonate-production system.
- ANALYSIS: Founder effects, drift and adaptive radiation create distinct lineages; species-area limits, edge effects, invasives and habitat fragmentation increase extinction risk.
- QUALIFICATION: Not every island is species-poor or equally fragile; area, age, elevation, habitat diversity and connectivity vary.
- VERDICT: Conservation must protect connected habitat processes and biosecurity, not only individual species.
- Why this earns marks: it combines theory, Indian examples, vulnerability mechanisms and a non-deterministic caveat.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Endemism != total richness.
2. Low redundancy is the key vulnerability phrase.

**UPSC TRAPS**

**WRONG:** Isolation has only negative effects.  
**CORRECT:** It also creates evolutionary distinctiveness.

**MAINS ANGLE**

*Isolation -> endemism -> low redundancy -> threats -> response.*

**STUDY LINK**

Main Module 10.

**HIGH**

## Original Mains practice 3 - 15 marks: freshwater and carrying capacity

GS-I / GS-III  
Geography

**NEWS TRIGGER**

Analyse why freshwater and waste, rather than land area alone, determine carrying capacity on small islands. Answer in 250 words.

**STATIC THEORY**

- CLAIM: Island carrying capacity is set by the least flexible life-support system, often freshwater and waste assimilation rather than gross land area.
- NAMED EVIDENCE: Lakshadweep depends on rain-fed freshwater lenses vulnerable to pumping and overwash; Great Nicobar's EC prohibits project groundwater and Galathea River withdrawal and proposes reservoirs.
- ANALYSIS: Population and tourism create peak demand; rainfall variability, storage, leakage and salinity constrain supply. Sewage, solid/hazardous waste and reverse logistics face limited land and marine-pollution risk.
- QUALIFICATION: Technology can expand capacity through reuse, desalination or shipment, but energy, brine, cost, maintenance and extreme-event failure create residual limits.
- VERDICT: Phase occupancy to verified safe yield, treatment and emergency storage; publish dashboards and stop growth when margins fail.
- Why this earns marks: it compares island types, uses project conditions, explains system constraints and gives measurable triggers.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. High rainfall is not dependable safe yield.
2. Waste capacity includes residual disposal.

**UPSC TRAPS**

**WRONG:** Desalination removes all limits.  
**CORRECT:** Energy, brine, cost and redundancy remain.

**MAINS ANGLE**

*Water budget + waste chain + peak demand + trigger.*

**STUDY LINK**

Main Module 12.

**HIGH**

## Original Mains practice 4 - 15 marks: project status and law

GS-I / GS-III  
Geography

**NEWS TRIGGER**

Why is it incorrect to describe the Great Nicobar project through a binary 'cleared/not cleared' label? Answer in 250 words.

**STATIC THEORY**

- CLAIM: The project is a bundle of components and statutory routes at different stages, so a binary label erases legal and implementation distinctions.
- NAMED EVIDENCE: Conditional Stage-I forest approval was issued 27 Oct 2022; EC/ICRZ clearance on 4 Nov 2022; Galathea Bay became a Major Port on 4 Sep 2024; PPPAC referral occurred 31 Dec 2025.
- ANALYSIS: Forest diversion, environment/coastal appraisal, wildlife/biodiversity, tribal safeguards, finance/PPP, tender and construction require separate evidence.
- STATUS/QUALIFICATION: Parliament said on 12 Feb 2026 that Stage-II/final forest approval had not been granted and later litigation remained sub judice. A 2026 PIB FAQ cites the 2023 NGT order; this does not close later cases.
- VERDICT: State component, instrument, stage, conditions, competent source and date before judging legality or progress.
- Why this earns marks: precise chronology, legal-stage separation, source conflict and a usable rule replace slogans.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. EC is not Stage-II.
2. Major Port notification is not construction.

**UPSC TRAPS**

- WRONG:** One clearance settles the entire project.
- CORRECT:** Each route has distinct conditions and evidence.

**MAINS ANGLE**

*Chronology + legal matrix + current limit.*

**STUDY LINK**

Main Modules 19 and 22.

**HIGH**

## Original Mains practice 5 - 20 marks: strategic-ecological balance

GS-I / GS-III  
Geography

**NEWS TRIGGER**

Critically evaluate whether strategic infrastructure and biodiversity conservation can be reconciled on Great Nicobar. Answer in 300 words.

**STATIC THEORY**

- CLAIM: Reconciliation is possible only for impacts that can be avoided, bounded and adaptively governed; it is not guaranteed by strategic importance or mitigation budgets.
- NAMED EVIDENCE: Official objectives include transshipment, airport, power, connectivity and maritime presence. Official conditions address forests, turtles, corals, water, monitoring and tribal welfare.
- ANALYSIS: Strategic resilience depends on functioning ecosystems, water, hazard-safe lifelines and social legitimacy. Conversely, strict no-development rhetoric may ignore connectivity, HADR and national-security needs.
- HARD LIMITS: old-growth fragmentation, endemic habitat, nesting beaches, active-margin extreme risk and cultural landscapes may be non-substitutable. Off-island afforestation cannot reproduce all island functions.
- QUALIFICATION: Risks are assessed pathways, not realised outcomes; official safeguards deserve testing, not dismissal. Yet Stage-II absence and pending cases make unconditional implementation claims unsafe.
- VERDICT: compare alternatives; declare no-go assets; phase demand; require independent monitoring and public condition-wise compliance; enforce ecological, social and disaster stop/go triggers.
- Why this earns marks: critical evaluation gives both cases, identifies non-negotiable limits, uses current status and provides implementable reconciliation conditions.



**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Strategic value and ecological value can reinforce resilience.
2. Some impacts remain irreversible.

**UPSC TRAPS**

**WRONG:** Reconciliation means every impact can be offset.

**CORRECT:** It begins with avoidance and accepts hard limits.

**MAINS ANGLE**

*Benefit -> dependency -> hard limits -> status -> conditions.*

**STUDY LINK**

Main Modules 17-23.

**HIGH**

## Original Mains practice 6 - 20 marks: governance framework

GS-I / GS-III  
Geography

**NEWS TRIGGER**

Propose an institutional framework for transparent, rights-respecting and disaster-resilient island development. Answer in 300 words.

**STATIC THEORY**

- CLAIM: Island governance needs one public programme architecture that links statutory approvals to ecological, social, service and hazard outcomes.
- NAMED EVIDENCE: Great Nicobar's multi-committee structure and INCOIS warning chain provide building blocks; Shompen Policy supplies integrity and contact principles.
- ANALYSIS: Establish an independent island observatory; publish baselines, permits and condition dashboards; integrate coastal/forest/wildlife/tribal/disaster authorities; audit water, waste, habitat and evacuation capacity before each phase.
- RIGHTS: use culturally appropriate continuing participation, health safeguards, grievance remedies, livelihood-access indicators and NCST/tribal-welfare oversight without exposing sensitive locations.
- ADAPTATION: require no-go assets, alternatives, cumulative assessment, emergency redundancy and pre-agreed pause/redesign/stop thresholds.
- QUALIFICATION: Central coordination reduces fragmentation but must not override statutory independence or local voice.
- VERDICT: release finance and occupancy only after independently verified phase gates, with judicial/administrative remedies for non-compliance.
- Why this earns marks: institutions, data, rights, disaster resilience and enforceable sequencing are integrated, with a centralisation caveat.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Transparency excludes sensitive tribal/security detail.
2. Phase gates need independent verification.

**UPSC TRAPS**

**WRONG:** One committee guarantees accountability.

**CORRECT:** Mandate, data, independence and remedy matter.

**MAINS ANGLE**

*Institution -> data -> rights -> capacity -> triggers -> remedy.*

**STUDY LINK**

Main Module 22-23.

**HIGH****Remedial error matrix****GS-I / GS-III**

Geography

**KEY DATA**

| Error                         | Repair rule                       | Return to   |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------|
| all A&N; volcanic             | write mixed subduction system     | Modules 3-4 |
| coral cay as bedrock          | write reef sediment budget        | Module 5    |
| channel confusion             | use 10-9-8 mnemonic               | Module 6    |
| biosphere = national park     | separate legal categories         | Module 9    |
| ecosystem as unlimited shield | add threshold                     | Module 11   |
| warning centre = preparedness | complete last mile                | Module 14   |
| ST = PVTG                     | use official list                 | Module 15   |
| clearance = construction      | use status ladder                 | Module 19   |
| official projection = outcome | state indicator and limit         | Module 20   |
| offset = equivalence          | state non-substitutable functions | Module 23   |

**STATIC THEORY**

- Repeat MCQs until two consecutive correct or two of three correct.
- Rewrite every wrong option as a correct one-line statement.
- For Mains, diagnose which element is missing: claim, evidence, mechanism, qualification or verdict.

**MUST-KNOW FACTS**

1. Most errors are classification or stage errors.
2. A dated status line often prevents current-affairs overclaim.

**UPSC TRAPS****WRONG:** Adding more facts fixes weak analysis.**CORRECT:** Repair the causal or legal distinction first.**MAINS ANGLE***Use the error matrix after every timed attempt.***STUDY LINK**

All modules.

HIGH

## Examiner checklist and rapid answer templates

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

### EXAMINER CHECKLIST AND RAPID ANSWER TEMPLATES - EVIDENCE AND RECALL MATRIX

| Question type     | Template                                                                    |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| origin/comparison | define -> process diagram -> named examples -> contrasts -> caveat          |
| ecology           | service -> pressure -> threshold -> evidence -> governance                  |
| hazard            | source -> propagation -> site effect -> exposure -> warning/evacuation      |
| project           | aims -> dated status -> benefits -> risks -> law -> conditions -> verdict   |
| tribal rights     | classification -> policy/law -> indirect impacts -> participation -> remedy |
| strategy          | location -> capability -> constraint -> resilience -> bounded verdict       |

### EXAMINER CHECKLIST AND RAPID ANSWER TEMPLATES - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Underline directive words and answer each explicitly.
- Use one compact map/process figure, not decorative art.
- Name the source date for every legal/project claim.
- Finish with a prioritised verdict, not 'balance is needed'.
- Check that inferred and provisional objective keys remain labelled.

#### EXAMINER CHECKLIST AND RAPID ANSWER TEMPLATES - RAPID RECALL

1. Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.
2. Why this earns marks should identify directive fidelity and value addition.

#### EXAMINER CHECKLIST AND RAPID ANSWER TEMPLATES - ERROR CHECKS

**WRONG:** A conclusion repeats the introduction.

**CORRECT:** A verdict ranks action and names conditions.

#### EXAMINER CHECKLIST AND RAPID ANSWER TEMPLATES - PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

*Final workbook page: use before timed practice.*

#### EXAMINER CHECKLIST AND RAPID ANSWER TEMPLATES - NEXT REVISION LINK

Main final register notes.